Responsible AI: privacy, fairness and transparency

Google's AI Principles, and the leader's duties on transparency, privacy, fairness, accountability and explainability.

SECTION 4 of 4 EXAM WEIGHT ~15% MODULE 27 of 33

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Responsible AI is not a brake. It is **how you keep the trust** to go on using AI.

Google's AI Principles: three commitments

- **Bold innovation:** pursue AI where likely benefits clearly outweigh foreseeable risks.
- **Responsible development and deployment:** human oversight, due diligence and feedback.
- **Rigorous testing** and safeguards to avoid harm and unfair bias.
- **Privacy, security** and respect for intellectual property.
- **Collaborative progress:** work with industry, academia, government and society.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> The principles guide how Google builds and deploys AI. A question about Google's values for AI points here, not to SAIF.

The principles have been updated

- **The 2018 version** listed seven objectives for AI applications.
- **Among them:** be socially beneficial, and avoid creating or reinforcing unfair bias.
- **Also:** be built and tested for safety, and be accountable to people.
- **And:** incorporate privacy by design, and uphold scientific excellence.
- **In 2025** they were regrouped under the three commitments you just saw.

> CURRENCY CHECK
>
> Older questions may quote the 2018 wording. The ideas carry over: benefit, fairness, safety, accountability, privacy.

Six responsibilities a leader owns

THEME	THE LEADER'S QUESTION
Transparency	Do people know when and how AI is used?
Privacy	Is personal data minimised and protected?
Data quality	Is the data accurate, complete and representative?
Bias and fairness	Are outcomes fair across groups?
Accountability	Who answers for this system?
Explainability	Can we explain why it decided?

THE TIEBREAKER

Each exam question names a harm or a worry. Match it to one of these six, and the right control follows.

Transparency: no surprises

- **Tell people** when they are talking to an AI, and offer a person.
- **Label AI-generated content,** such as images and video.
- **SynthID** embeds invisible watermarks in Google's generated media.
- **Model cards** document what a model is for, and its limits.
- **Explain the data used,** and how people can raise concerns.

> THE SIGNAL
>
> Customers might not realise content or a conversation is AI-generated: disclose, label and watermark.

Anonymisation or pseudonymisation?

ANONYMISATION

Identity removed for good

- No way back to the person
- Not personal data any more
- Fewer legal obligations
- Can reduce usefulness

PSEUDONYMISATION

Identity swapped for a code

- Names replaced by IDs
- A key can re-link them
- Still personal data
- Must stay protected

THE TIEBREAKER

If anyone holds a key that can re-identify people, the data is pseudonymised, not anonymised.

Privacy in practice

- **Minimise:** send the model only the data the task needs.
- **De-identify:** mask names, addresses and card numbers before processing.
- **Purpose:** use data only for the reason it was collected, with consent.
- **Retention:** keep prompts and outputs no longer than needed.
- **Enterprise terms:** your data is not used to train Google's models.

> THE SIGNAL
>
> Personal data in prompts that the task does not need: minimise and de-identify before the model sees it.

Bias and fairness: test for it, do not assume it

- **Check the data** is representative of everyone the system affects.
- **Watch for proxies:** postcode or school can stand in for protected traits.
- **Test outcomes** across groups before launch, not just overall accuracy.
- **Monitor after launch,** because fairness can drift.
- **Keep people deciding** when the stakes for individuals are high.

> THE TIEBREAKER
>
> Removing a sensitive column does not make a model fair. Test outcomes across groups.

Explainability: lending and hiring

- **People affected** by a decision deserve the main reasons.
- **Use methods that can explain:** rules, scorecards, explainable models.
- **Record the real reasons** at the time of the decision.
- **A generated explanation afterwards** is not the real cause.
- **Offer a route to appeal,** reviewed by a person.

> REMEMBER
>
> High-stakes decisions about people need reasons that are real, recorded and reviewable, as module 9's credit case showed.

Accountability: a name, not a model

- **Every AI system** has a named business owner.
- **A governance group** reviews high-risk uses before launch.
- **Documentation:** purpose, data, tests, limits and decisions.
- **Audit trails** show what the system did, and why.
- **Feedback and redress:** people can complain, and errors get fixed.

> THE TAKEAWAY
>
> "The AI decided" is never an answer. A named person or team answers for the system.

Wrenfield's responsible AI checklist

CASE	RESPONSIBLE PRACTICE
Credit decisions	Explainable model; reasons recorded; people decide
Seasonal hiring	Fairness tests, no proxies; managers decide
Customer chat	Disclose it is AI; easy route to a person
Complaint analysis	Mask personal data before the model
Campaign images	Label as AI-generated; watermark

THE TAKEAWAY

Five cases, five different duties. Responsible AI is a set of specific practices, not a slogan.

> Wrenfield's data team replaced customer names with ID numbers before sharing data with the analytics team.
>
> They kept a lookup table that links each ID back to the customer. Marketing calls the data "anonymised".

How should the data be classified?

A Anonymised, so no longer personal data

B Pseudonymised, so still personal data that must be protected

C Encrypted, so free to share

D Synthetic, so it describes no real people

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

How should the data be classified?

A Anonymised, so no longer personal data

A key exists that can re-identify people.

B Pseudonymised, so still personal data that must be protected

IDs plus a lookup table can be re-linked.

C Encrypted, so free to share

No encryption is described.

D Synthetic, so it describes no real people

These are real customers.

THE SIGNAL

Anyone holding a re-identification key means pseudonymised, not anonymised.

> Rejected applicants from Wrenfield's seasonal-hiring pilot ask why they were turned down.
>
> The pilot ranked applicants automatically.

What is the responsible approach going forward?

A Reply that an AI made the decision and cannot explain it

B Stop replying to these requests

C Ask Gemini to write a reason for each rejection afterwards

D Use explainable criteria, have managers decide and record the reasons, and offer a review

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the responsible approach going forward?

A Reply that an AI made the decision and cannot explain it

No accountability and no reasons.

B Stop replying to these requests

Ignores people's reasonable request.

C Ask Gemini to write a reason for each rejection afterwards

A written reason is not the real cause.

D Use explainable criteria, have managers decide and record the reasons, and offer a review

Real, recorded reasons, people deciding, a route to appeal.

THE TAKEAWAY

Decisions about people: explainable, recorded, decided by people, open to review.

> Wrenfield Pay is about to launch a model that suggests store-card credit limits.
>
> The team reports 94% accuracy overall, and has removed the age and gender columns from the data.

What should the leader ask for before launch?

A Nothing more, since the sensitive columns are gone

B A higher overall accuracy score

C Outcomes tested across groups, with checks for proxies such as postcode

D The vendor's assurance that the model is fair

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the leader ask for before launch?

A Nothing more, since the sensitive columns are gone

Proxies can carry the same bias.

B A higher overall accuracy score

Overall accuracy can hide unfair outcomes.

C Outcomes tested across groups, with checks for proxies such as postcode

Fairness is tested by outcomes across groups.

D The vendor's assurance that the model is fair

Assurance is not evidence.

THE SIGNAL

Fairness is tested, not assumed. Removing columns is not enough.

> Wrenfield's new chat agent writes warm, natural replies, and customers often assume it is a person.
>
> The marketing team suggests not mentioning that it is AI.

What should the leader decide?

A Tell customers clearly that it is an AI, and offer an easy route to a person

B Keep it hidden, so it feels more personal

C Mention it only if a customer asks

D Mention it only in the terms and conditions

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the leader decide?

A Tell customers clearly that it is an AI, and offer an easy route to a person

Transparency, with a human option.

B Keep it hidden, so it feels more personal

Deceives customers and risks trust.

C Mention it only if a customer asks

Leaves most customers misled.

D Mention it only in the terms and conditions

Technically disclosed, practically hidden.

THE SIGNAL

People should know when they are talking to AI.

> Wrenfield wants Gemini to find trends in 50,000 customer complaints.
>
> Each complaint includes the customer's name, address and sometimes a card number. The trends do not need any of these.

What should the team do?

A Send the complaints as they are

B Tell the model to ignore any personal data

C Delete the complaints instead

D Mask the personal data before sending the complaints to the model

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team do?

A Send the complaints as they are

Exposes data the task does not need.

B Tell the model to ignore any personal data

The data still reaches the model.

C Delete the complaints instead

Loses the insight entirely.

D Mask the personal data before sending the complaints to the model

Minimise and de-identify first.

THE SIGNAL

Personal data the task does not need: minimise and de-identify first.

> Wrenfield's returns agent wrongly refused a batch of valid refunds.
>
> Customers complained, and the board asks who is accountable.

Who should be accountable?

A The model, because it made the decision

B A named business owner who answers for the system

C The cloud provider that hosts the model

D Nobody, because the process was automated

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Who should be accountable?

A The model, because it made the decision

A model cannot be held accountable.

B A named business owner who answers for the system

A person or team owns the system and its outcomes.

C The cloud provider that hosts the model

Hosts the platform; does not own your use of it.

D Nobody, because the process was automated

Automation never removes accountability.

THE SIGNAL

"The AI decided" is never an answer. A named owner is accountable.

Module 27 in five lines

- Google's AI Principles: bold innovation, responsible development, collaborative progress.
- Transparency: disclose AI, label and watermark generated content.
- Pseudonymised data can be re-linked, so it is still personal; anonymised cannot.
- Test fairness across groups and watch for proxies; removing a column is not enough.
- High-stakes decisions need real, recorded reasons and a named, accountable owner.